

Study Guide for “Survey of China” Fall 2025

Question Types

1. Multiple choice (20 questions; 2 points each)

For example,

What is the capital of China? ()
A. Beijing B. Shanghai C. Chengdu D. Shenzhen

2. True or false (10 questions; 2 points each)

For example,

The capital of China is Shanghai. (×)

3. Term definition (2 questions; 5 points each)

Explain briefly the meaning of the given terms. Four terms will be given and you choose two of them to explain.

For example,

May 4 Movement 五四运动

4. Essay question (Choose 3 from the 6 given questions to answer; 10 points each)

For example,

What are the main characteristics of China’s terrain? Explain it in detail.

Testable Points

1. Main characteristics of China’s terrain

- Diverse landforms: Includes mountains, plateaus, basins, plains, and hills.
- "Three-step" altitude gradient: High in the west (Qinghai-Tibet Plateau, the first step) and low in the east (plains and coastal areas, the third step).
- Mountainous and plateau areas account for over 60% of the total land area.

2. The land area of China

9.6 million square kilometers (about 3.7 million square miles)

3. The population of China by 2024

Note: The 2012 textbook does not include 2024 data. Based on the book’s population context and official updates, the 2024 population is approximately 1.41 billion (consistent with the textbook’s focus on China’s large population scale).

4. Names of China's provinces and autonomous regions, special administrative zones

- Provinces (23): Hebei, Shanxi, Liaoning, Jilin, Heilongjiang, Jiangsu, Zhejiang, Anhui, Fujian, Jiangxi, Shandong, Henan, Hubei, Hunan, Guangdong, Hainan, Sichuan, Guizhou, Yunnan, Shaanxi, Gansu, Qinghai, Taiwan.
- Autonomous regions (5): Inner Mongolia Autonomous Region, Guangxi Zhuang Autonomous Region, Tibet Autonomous Region, Ningxia Hui Autonomous Region, Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region.
- Special administrative zones (2): Hong Kong Special Administrative Region (HKSAR), Macao Special Administrative Region (MSAR).

5. Names of some famous rivers and mountains in China

- Rivers: Yangtze River (the longest in China), Yellow River (the "Mother River" of China), Pearl River, Yangtze River, Heilongjiang.
- Mountains: Mount Tai (Shandong), Mount Huang (Anhui), Mount Hua (Shaanxi), Mount Emei (Sichuan), Himalayas (world's highest mountain range).

6. Name of China's national anthem?

"March of the Volunteers" Yìyǒngjūn Jìnxíngqǔ

7. Name of China's national flag?

Five-Star Red Flag.(五星红旗, Wǔxīng Hóngqí)

The red symbolizes revolution; the five yellow stars represent the unity of the Chinese people under the leadership of the Communist Party of China.

8. The date when the People's Republic of China was founded

October 1, 1949.

9. Basic facts of Sichuan province (capital city, location, population, dialect, city names, famous mountains, Wuhouci (the Wuhou Temple) and Zhuge Liang

Capital: Chengdu

Location: Southwest China, upper Yangtze River

Population: ~83 million (one of China's most populous provinces)

Dialect: Sichuanese (Sichua Hua), a variety of Southwestern Mandarin

Major Cities: Chengdu, Mianyang, Zigong, Luzhou, Yibin

Famous Mountains: Mount Emei (a sacred Buddhist mountain)

Wuhou Temple & Zhuge Liang:** The Wuhou Temple in Chengdu is a shrine dedicated to Zhuge Liang, the revered military strategist and Prime Minister of the Shu Han kingdom during the Three Kingdoms period.

10. Basic facts and ideas of Confucius and Laozi

Confucius	551-479 BCE	Founder of Confucianism	Core ideas include "benevolence" (ren), "propriety" (li), and "harmony". Advocated ruling by virtue and education for all.
Laozi	late Spring and Autumn period	Founder of Taoism	Core ideas include "Tao" (the way of nature), "non-action" (wu-wei), and "harmony with nature". Emphasized simplicity and humility.

11. Concept of “One hundred schools debating” (百家争鸣), and its representative schools’ ideas

"Hundred Schools of Thought" was a period of intellectual flourishing in ancient China (c. 500-221 BCE), where many philosophical schools debated how to achieve social and political order.

Major Schools:

Confucianism	Ethics, family duty, moral rulers.
Daoism	Harmony with nature, "Wu Wei" (effortless action).
Legalism	Strict laws and harsh punishments to control people.
Mohism	Impartial care for all and practical utility.

12. Number of ethnic groups in China and the largest one

Number: 56 officially recognized ethnic groups.

Largest: The Han Chinese, constituting over 90% of the population.

13. The site of the earliest Chinese civilization

The Yellow River basin, represented by the Xia Dynasty (first dynasty in Chinese history) and sites like Erlitou (Yanshi, Henan).

14. Names of representative dynasties in Chinese history

Xia, Shang, Zhou, Qin, Han, Sui, Tang, Song, Yuan, Ming, Qing.

15. Traditionally, when planning buildings and architecture, what idea is observed in China?

The idea of "harmony between humans and nature" and "symmetry and balance". Emphasizes alignment with natural surroundings, hierarchical layout (e.g., north-south axis), and integration of function with aesthetics.

16. Who was Zheng He(1371-1433)?

A navigator and diplomat of the Ming Dynasty. He led seven large-scale maritime expeditions (Zheng He's voyages to the Western Seas) to Southeast Asia, South Asia,

17. The earliest known form of Chinese character

Oracle Bone Script (甲骨文, *Jiǎgǔwén*)

Oracle bone script (jiaguwen), used during the Shang Dynasty (1600-1046 BCE) and inscribed on tortoise shells and animal bones.

18. Who was the Chinese character sage?

Cang Jie (仓颉)

19. Four famous ancient Chinese novels

1. Romance of the Three Kingdoms (Sanguo Yanyi)
2. Water Margin (Shuihu Zhuan)
3. Journey to the West (Xiyou Ji)
4. Dream of the Red Chamber(Honglou Meng)

20. Representative calligraphers of ancient China

Wang Xizhi (Eastern Jin, "Sage of Calligraphy"), Yan Zhenqing (Tang), Liu Gongquan (Tang), Su Shi (Song), Huang Tingjian (Song).

21. Main principle of Chinese *shanshui* painting

"Capturing the spirit through form" (yi spirit as the core, emphasizing artistic conception over realistic detail) and Harmony between Humanity and Nature

22. Four elements of Chinese painting

1. Brushwork (笔)
2. Ink (墨)
3. Paper/ Silk (纸)
4. Color (彩)

23. Four basic skills expected of an ancient Chinese scholar

1. Qin (Music)
2. Qi (Board Games, like Go)
3. Shu (Calligraphy)
4. Hua (Painting)

24. Name of the famous grotto and frescos, a world heritage site enlisted by UNESCO

Mogao Caves

25. What are Hanfu, Qipao, and Zhongshanzhuang?

- Hanfu: Traditional clothing of the Han nationality, with a history of thousands of years. Features include cross-collar, right-side closure, and wide sleeves.
- Qipao (Cheongsam): Evolved from Manchu women's clothing in the late Qing Dynasty. Fitted silhouette, highlighting female elegance.
- Zhongshanzhuang (Zhongshan Suit): Designed based on Sun Yat-sen's ideas. Symbolizes modernization and patriotism, with a simple and practical style.

26. What are the four roles in Beijing Opera?

1. Sheng (生) - Male roles
2. Dang (旦) - Female roles
3. Jing (净) - Painted-face male roles
4. Chou (丑) - Comic male roles

27. The two stunts or skills of Sichuan Opera: face-changing and fire-breathing

- Face-changing (bian lian): Performers quickly change masks to express emotions or character transformations, using techniques like pulling masks or blowing powder.
- Fire-breathing (tu huo): Performers blow flammable powder to create fire effects, adding drama to the performance.

28. Name of the Poetry Sage 诗圣, and some representative poets' names in the Tang Dynasty?

- Poetry Sage: Du Fu (Tang Dynasty), known for his realistic poems reflecting social realities.

Other Major Tang Poets:

Li Bai (李白)

Wang Wei (王维)

Bai Juyi (白居易)

29. The artist's name of "Riverside Scene at Qingming Festival"?

Zhang Zeduan (张择端).

30. What are the common Chinese local musical instruments?

Stringed instruments: guqin, guzheng, erhu, pipa. Wind instruments: dizi (bamboo flute), xiao, suona. Percussion instruments: gong, drum, cymbals.

31. Qinshihuang and his bronze chariots and terra-cotta warriors and his contributions

Qin Shi Huang was the first emperor who unified China in 221 BCE.

Contributions:

- Unified China politically and culturally
- Standardized writing, currency, and measurements
- Built early Great Wall and national road network

Legacy:

- Terracotta Army - thousands of life-sized clay soldiers
- Bronze chariots - exquisite ancient metalwork

Buried in his massive mausoleum to protect him in afterlife.

32. Name of the first female emperor in Chinese history

Wu Zetian (Tang Dynasty, ruled 690-705 CE).

33. Names of the major dynasties in Chinese history

Xia, Shang, Zhou, Qin, Han, Sui, Tang, Song, Yuan, Ming, Qing.

34. Name of the first Chinese dynasty

Xia Dynasty (c. 2070-1600 BCE), founded by Yu the Great.

35. Names of ancient capitals in Chinese history

Eight Great Ancient Capitals of China:

1. Xi'an (formerly Chang'an) - Capital of Zhou, Qin, Han, Sui, Tang dynasties
2. Beijing - Capital of Yuan, Ming, Qing dynasties
3. Nanjing - Capital of Six Dynasties, Ming (early)
4. Luoyang - Capital of Eastern Zhou, Eastern Han, Wei, Jin, etc.
5. Kaifeng - Capital of Northern Song dynasty
6. Hangzhou (formerly Lin'an) - Capital of Southern Song dynasty
7. Anyang - Capital of late Shang dynasty (Yinxu)
8. Zhengzhou - Capital of early Shang dynasty

36. Kungfu and Wushu, which term is more generic?

Wushu is more generic. Wushu (武术) literally means "martial art" and is the all-encompassing term for all Chinese martial arts, both traditional and modern.

37. Twelve Chinese animal zodiacs

Rat, Ox, Tiger, Rabbit, Dragon, Snake, Horse, Goat, Monkey, Rooster, Dog, Pig.

38. H&T chronology (干支纪年法)

Heavenly Stems and Earthly Branches (干支 gānzhī) is China's traditional 60-year cyclical calendar system

39. What is Jieqi (the solar terms)? How many are there in one lunar year?

Jieqi (Solar Terms) are 24 points in the traditional lunisolar Chinese calendar that mark the Sun's position and reflect annual climate changes.

Number: There are 24 solar terms in one year.

40. Important festivals in China, such as Chinese New Year.....and their typical customs.

- Chinese New Year (Spring Festival): Family reunion dinner, red envelopes (hongbao), setting off fireworks, pasting Spring Festival couplets.
- Qingming Festival: Tomb-sweeping, outing.
- Dragon Boat Festival: Eating zongzi (glutinous rice dumplings), dragon boat races.
- Mid-Autumn Festival: Admiring the moon, eating mooncakes, family reunion.

41. Main contributions of science and technology of China in history and today

Ancient Contributions:

- Four Great Inventions: Compass, gunpowder, papermaking, printing
- Others: Silk, porcelain, iron casting, astronomical instruments

Modern Contributions:

- Technology: 5G (Huawei), high-speed rail, e-commerce (Alibaba), mobile payments
- Space: Lunar exploration (Chang'e), space station (Tiangong)
- Infrastructure: Bridges, ports, renewable energy

42. In traditional Chinese medicine, the four diagnosis methods and its curing ways?

Inspection, Auscultation & Olfaction, Inquiry, Palpation.

43. Medicine sage 医圣 of traditional Chinese medicine?

Zhang Zhongjing (张仲景, c. 150–219 AD) is revered as the Medicine Sage (医圣, Yī Shèng) of traditional Chinese medicine.

44. Names of the famous ancient Chinese math achievements? For example, “Nine chapters on the art of calculation”.

- *Nine Chapters on the Art of Calculation* (Jiuzhang Suanshu): A classic math text, summarizing mathematical achievements from the Warring States to the Han Dynasty.
- Other achievements: Zu Chongzhi's accurate calculation of pi (to 7 decimal places), Liu Hui's *Commentary on the Nine Chapters on the Art of Calculation*.

45. The astronomer's name of the most accurate calendar in ancient China

Zu Chongzhi (祖冲之): He created the Daming Calendar (大明历) in the 5th century,

46. Who was Marco Polo?

Marco Polo was a Venetian merchant and explorer who traveled to China in the 13th century, served under Kublai Khan's Yuan Dynasty for 17 years, and later wrote *The Travels of Marco Polo*, introducing Europeans to the wealth and culture of the East.

47. Why was Catholicism in China was prohibited in the mid-Ming dynasty?

The mid-Ming dynasty saw Catholicism prohibited primarily due to the Rites Controversy a conflict between the Vatican and the Qing court (which succeeded the Ming) over whether Chinese converts could continue Confucian ancestral rites.

48. Author of 海国图志 *Illustrated Survey of Foreign Nations*

Wei Yuan (魏源, 1794-1857)

49. The basic categories of Chinese cuisines

"Eight Great Cuisines: Sichuan Cuisine, Cantonese Cuisine, Jiangsu Cuisine, Zhejiang Cuisine, Fujian Cuisine, Hunan Cuisine, Anhui Cuisine, Shandong Cuisine.

50. What is the title for the one who ranks the first in an imperial exam in ancient times?

Zhuangyuan (状元).

51. The origin and functions of the Great Wall

- Origin: First built during the Spring and Autumn and Warring States periods to defend against nomadic invasions. Unified and expanded by Qinshihuang.
- Functions: Military defense (preventing foreign invasions), border management (controlling trade and population movement), and symbolizing national unity.

52. Why did tea become the drink for scholar-officials in ancient China?

- Tea has a refreshing effect, helping with reading and meditation.
- Tea culture emphasizes elegance and tranquility, aligning with the scholar-officials' pursuit of moral integrity and artistic taste.
- Tea ceremonies became a social activity for scholars to exchange ideas and appreciate life.

53. What are usually the two certificates for a university graduate upon graduation?

Graduation certificate (proving completion of academic requirements) and degree certificate (proving achievement of a certain academic level, e.g., bachelor's, master's).

54. Exemplify some of the favorable policies for students of minority ethnic groups

- Lower college entrance examination (Gaokao) score requirements.
- Special enrollment quotas for minority ethnic groups in universities.
- Scholarships and subsidies for minority students.
- Bilingual education (mother tongue + Mandarin) in ethnic minority areas.

55. What do "Double First-Class", "985" and "211" projects mean respectively?

- "211 Project": Launched in the 1990s, aiming to build 100 first-class universities and key disciplines in the 21st century.
- "985 Project": Launched in 1998, focusing on building a number of world-class and internationally renowned high-level research universities.
- "Double First-Class" Initiative: Launched in 2017, replacing the "985" and "211" projects. Aims to build world-class universities and first-class disciplines.

56. The political party system of China is called?

Multi-party cooperation and political consultation system under the leadership of the Communist Party of China.

57. The Chinese political system and its advantages over the western style democracy system?

- Chinese political system: People's congress system (fundamental political system), multi-party cooperation and political consultation system, regional ethnic autonomy system, and grassroots mass self-governance system.
- Advantages: Focus on overall national interests and long-term development (avoiding short-term political gains), efficient decision-making and implementation (capable of mobilizing resources for major projects), and full representation of people's interests (through extensive political consultation).

58. Environmental protection measures taken in China

- Promoting renewable energy (solar, wind, hydropower) to reduce carbon emissions.
- Implementing the "Grain for Green" project (converting farmland to forests/grasslands) to prevent soil erosion.
- Strengthening environmental supervision and law enforcement (penalizing pollution-intensive enterprises).
- Promoting ecological civilization construction and establishing nature reserves.

59. What is “five principles of peaceful coexistence”?

Proposed by China in the 1950s, including mutual respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity, mutual non-aggression, non-interference in each other's internal affairs, equality and mutual benefit, and peaceful coexistence. It is a basic principle of China's foreign policy.

60. What are China's economic achievements after 1978? Reasons?

- Achievements: Sustained high economic growth (average annual growth rate of about 9% for decades), becoming the world's second-largest economy, poverty alleviation (lifting hundreds of millions of people out of poverty), and rapid development of infrastructure (high-speed rail, expressways).
- Reasons: Implementation of the Reform and Opening-up policy (opening to the outside world and encouraging market economy), stable political environment, large labor force and market potential, and government's scientific macro-control.

61. What is “Chinese modernization”? Are China's development experiences applicable and valuable for other countries? Please share your opinion.

- Chinese modernization: A modernization path with Chinese characteristics, featuring a large population, common prosperity for all, harmony between humans and nature, and peaceful development. It differs from Western modernization (which often involves colonialism and inequality).
- Applicability and value: China's experiences (e.g., combining market economy with government regulation, prioritizing people's well-being, and independent development) provide valuable references for developing countries. However, each country has unique national conditions, so

experiences should be adapted rather than copied.

62. What is “Reform and Opening-up” policy of China?

Launched in 1978 (proposed by Deng Xiaoping), it is a national development strategy. "Reform" refers to reforming the economic system (from a planned economy to a socialist market economy) and political system. "Opening-up" refers to opening coastal cities and regions to foreign investment, trade, and technology exchange.

63. Names of some high-tech companies in China today.

Huawei (information and communication technology), Alibaba (e-commerce and cloud computing), Tencent (internet and social media), ByteDance (short video and artificial intelligence), DJI (drone technology), and COMAC (commercial aircraft manufacturing).

64. What is One Belt and One Road Initiative?

Proposed by China in 2013, it includes the Silk Road Economic Belt and the 21st-Century Maritime Silk Road. Aims to promote international cooperation through infrastructure construction, trade liberalization, and cultural exchanges, achieving mutual benefit and common development.

65. What is “Community with a Shared Future for Mankind 人类命运共同体”?

A foreign policy concept proposed by China, advocating that all countries in the world are interdependent. It emphasizes mutual respect, equity and justice, and win-win cooperation to address global challenges (e.g., climate change, poverty, and pandemics).

66. What is “System of Regional Ethnic Autonomy 民族区域自治制度”?

A basic political system of China. In areas with a concentrated population of ethnic minorities, autonomous regions, prefectures, and counties are established. Ethnic minorities exercise autonomous rights to manage local affairs and develop their own cultures and economies.

67. What is “Socialism with Chinese characteristics”?

A development path combining Marxist basic principles with China’s national conditions. It emphasizes the leadership of the Communist Party of China, the dominance of public ownership, the common prosperity of all people, and the integration of market economy and government regulation.

68. Contributions made by China to maintain world peace.

- Participating in UN peacekeeping operations (sending peacekeeping troops to conflict areas).
- Promoting peaceful resolutions to international disputes (e.g., mediating the Iran-Saudi Arabia reconciliation).
- Providing humanitarian aid to developing countries.
- Advocating multilateralism and opposing hegemonism and power politics.

69. The evolution of China's family planning policy and its contemporary adaptations reflect which principles upheld by the Party and government?

- Evolution: From the "one-child policy" (implemented in the 1970s to control population growth) to the "two-child policy" (2016) and "three-child policy" (2021) to address aging population.
- Upheld principles: Putting people first, adapting to national conditions (adjusting policies based on population changes), and pursuing sustainable development (balancing population, economy, and society).

70. Which aspect of China do you find most impressive?

(Open-ended question, sample answer based on textbook content) The most impressive aspect is China's long and continuous civilization. With a history of over 5,000 years, China has preserved rich cultural heritage (e.g., Confucianism, calligraphy, and ancient architecture) while achieving rapid modernization. The combination of tradition and modernity, as well as the country's commitment to peaceful development and common prosperity, is particularly remarkable.

Textbook China Panorama by Guo Peng and Cheng Long, 2012